De-Optimization guide
Z-Reduction task
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What Prevents Joy: Z

Z is the evaluation/optimization load and blocks entry into Joy. So this is a Z Reduction Task. Joy switches on all at once, like a light being turned on.

Don’t search visually for occasions. Searching visually, is already an optimization.

Perturbations List

In A FPS Game

If possible, no thought at all, no mental imagery, just a blank mind, while doing the task with a video game.

You can also try instead:

Thought Without Owner

Briefly experience a thought as simply occurring, without emphasizing that *you* are producing it. *"A thought appeared."*

Changing direction

Direction is used toward a goal or to explore, to reach something. One tries to anticipate the best path.

Briefly changing direction for no reason breaks that optimization.

Just a sip

One often drinks what one needs to satiate.

Briefly taking only one sip breaks that optimization.

Stop just before

When one sees a game bonus, he will take advantage and automatically take it.

Briefly aborting and ignoring the bonus when one walks closely to it breaks that optimization.

Switch to a lower weapon

Briefly change weapons to something ordinary or just no the best.

No Result at the Exit

When leaving, do not decide whether the game was successful. Let it remain one game among others.

Micro movement

A little, unrhythmic, “stupid” movement that does nothing,

Walking

Salute, Don’t Verify

Salute an animal, don’t verify his reaction.

Look, Don’t Verify

Look at someone, don’t verify his reaction.

No Destination

Read a street arrow without converting it into a destination.

No Evaluation of Light

Notice a reflection on the floor or the brightness of an area without deciding whether the lighting is pleasant.

No Sound Source

Hear a sound before deciding what is its source.

A Slight Change of Course

While walking, change your speed very slightly, without a reason, then continue normally. Not enough to be theatrical, just enough to break the autopilot.

No Hurry

Without changing your destination, briefly behave as though arriving a fraction of a second earlier or later makes no difference.

Movements

Micro movement

In general, all movements are working toward a goal. It can be to maintain a social image, or to complete a task.

By doing a little, unrhythmic, “stupid” movement that does nothing, it breaks that optimization.

Stop Agency

See your hands movements as “it happened” instead of being the author.

Items

No Next Move

After turning an item in your hand, leave the next movement undecided.

Category Softening

Often, items are categorized to facilitate their use.

Soften categories. Briefly let an apple seem a little less clearly to be "an apple."

Object with the Wrong Past

Look at an ordinary object and briefly imagine that it came from an absurd past. A chair was once a boat, and a lamp was found in a cave. Do not explain it.

Wrong Material

Look at an object and briefly perceive it as made of the wrong material. A wall is soft, a cup is made of paper, a tree is metallic, a screen is cloth.

Pause Before Utility

After picking up an object, let it remain in your hand briefly before using it.

Many Before One

Briefly notice several objects together before one becomes the focus.

The Non-Possessive Gaze

Look at an appealing object as if it weren't for you. Not to buy, keep, use, or make part of your identity. Aim: to interrupt the conversion of the world into something to acquire.

Arbitrary Importance:

Often, importance is justified by use, meaning, or value.

Briefly label an *ordinary* item as important.

Colors Stand Out

Briefly see its color instead of its function.

Just an Object

Briefly notice an object without immediately relating it to a use or purpose.

Social Events

Hello for Nothing

Say "hello" without checking how it was received.

Approval Without Recipients

Generate a feeling of recognition, greeting, or welcoming, as if you were acknowledging someone, but with no recipient.

Passing By

After passing someone, do not review whether your movement, gaze, or hesitation appeared normal.

Don't Justify

Don't justify yourself too much. If late, just say "sorry, I am late".

Computer

Mouse Without a Task

Hold the mouse for a brief moment without any particular purpose.

Cursor Without Hurry

For a brief moment, let the exact timing of the next click matter a little less.

Cursor as an Object

Briefly notice the cursor as a visual shape rather than as a tool.

Cursor Forgot

Move the cursor toward a menu, then let it stop as if the cursor forgot what it was doing

Option and Setting

Read *an* option without converting it into "therefore I should/shouldn't choose it."

Notice *a* setting without immediately evaluating whether it is optimal.

Interrupted Reading

Open a file or page. Read a line, not the paragraph. Do not finish the sentence or look for what comes next.

Window Without a Center

A folder or desktop is open. Browse as if no file is the right one.

Shape Before Tool

See the play button, icon, or cursor as a patch of color for a second, before it becomes something to click. Then resume using it. Do not judge whether the patch was clear enough.

Unclosed Question

Looking at a title, tab, or filename, let “what about this one?” arise without answering or clicking. Let the question fade unfinished.

Word As Visual Object

Briefly notice a word as a visual object before reading it.

Nothing first

A second where no tab, no file is the priority.

Ordinary Cursor

Look at the cursor as if it was as important as the content

Background First

Look at an empty area before resuming

Sentence That Doesn't Finish

Think “I will click on..” and don’t complete.

One Moment Among Others

A click Is just one among others

Halfway Meaning

Briefly let something be understood only part way, while reading something a little bit complicated.

Media Files (music videos/youtube/news)

Media without a verdict.

A video launched, no evaluation for some seconds

Not This One, Not Another

For a moment, let multiple files simply remain possibilities, without selecting one.

Search Can Wait

Look at the results as if finding the best files can wait.

Leave It Unopened

Look at an interesting preview, don’t open it

Preview With no Imagning

Look at a Video thumbnail, don’t imagine the content of the video

Could Be Something Else

For a second, leave the impression that the image could represent something else, without looking for what.

No Value

For a moment, see only the file names, not their musical or narrative value.

No Genre

Look at a title as if you had no idea what genre of music it contains.

Switch Genre

Briefly imagine that a cheerful track is melancholic, or vice versa. Don’t try to check.

Interrupted Search

Start to search for a particular video, then abort

Half Choice

One image seems to become "the right one". Let this impression remain unfinished.

Shape First

Briefly notice the colors, shapes, and movement before the story becomes important.

No Optimal start

Press play without waiting for the "right moment."

Maybe

Maybe the next shot..." The prediction never becomes specific.

No Understanding

If something unusual appears, briefly allow several explanations without choosing one.

Movement First

Briefly notice the movement itself before identifying what is moving.

An Icon

Notice the music icon as a simple shape before its meaning becomes relevant.

Shape Before Function

Briefly notice the play button as a shape before it becomes something to click.

Title Without a Question

Read a title but don't treat it as a question that needs an answer.

Time

Single Glance

Check the time once. Do not immediately look again to confirm it.

Time Without Meaning

Look at the clock for a moment as if the numbers were simply another visual pattern, then continue normally.

Sometimes notice the current time without mentally calculating how long remains until the appointment.

Normal Year

Let the current year seem no more important than any other.

Remaining Time

After seeing the time, do not estimate how much time remains before the next event.

Action Pressure

Keep the current action local: walking past the table, turning around the pillar. Do not connect it to a larger sequence.

Completed.

An action reaches completion. Notice the completion itself for a moment.

A small action begins

A small action begins before any larger purpose becomes important.

Interval

After completing one small action, allow a brief interval before deciding what comes next.

No Replacement

Something ends. For a moment, nothing immediately replaces it.

Continue Without Checking

Don’t verify the current action when it ends.

In A shopping mall

Local Avoidance

Move around a person or obstacle only when necessary. Do not plan the entire trajectory in advance.

Either Side

When both sides of an obstacle are available, take one without comparing them.

No Recovery of Lost Ground

If you unintentionally return to a familiar aisle, continue normally. Do not correct the “mistake.”

Peripheral Product

Let one product enter your attention from the edge of vision. Do not immediately approach, identify, or evaluate it.

Unfinished Curiosity

Notice an unfamiliar object and allow the curiosity to remain unanswered.

Category Without Search

Read a department sign without converting it into a destination.

Product Without Function

Look briefly at a product without asking whether it is useful, affordable, or appropriate.

Pass Without Resistance

Notice an attractive product and continue walking without framing the action as resisting temptation.

The Forgotten Plan

Form a light intention, such as “perhaps I will visit that aisle,” then permit yourself to forget it.

No Time Reconstruction

Do not estimate how long the walk has lasted. If the time becomes known accidentally, do not use it to reorganize the walk.

Uninterpreted Sound

Let a short piece of music, an announcement, or a cart noise be heard without judging whether it improves or disrupts the experience.

Light Without Rating

Notice a reflection on the floor or the brightness of an area without deciding whether the lighting is pleasant.

Let the Person Pass

If another shopper changes your path, accept the temporary interruption without immediately reconstructing the optimal route.

No Result at the Exit

When leaving, do not decide whether the walk was successful. Let it remain one walk among others.

Mind

Naming Poor

You mentally name an element in a very poor way: "blue", "truck", "hand", "wall", "sound", "image".

Mind Unnamed Thought

Notice a thought without deciding whether it is planning, remembering, judging, or imagining.

Thought Passes First

When a thought appears, briefly let it pass before acting on it, even if the action is eventually performed.

Thought Without Owner

Briefly experience a thought as simply occurring, without emphasizing that *you* are producing it. *"A thought appeared."*

Incomplete Explanation

When the mind begins explaining something, let the explanation remain unfinished. "This happened because..."

Meaning Without Expansion

Understand a thought immediately, but do not elaborate on its implications.

Question Without Investigation

When a question arises spontaneously, allow it to remain unanswered for a few seconds .

Thought Without Importance

Briefly experience the current thought as neither especially important nor unimportant.

Uncompleted Memory
A memory is allowed to remain incomplete.

Incomplete Object

Imagine only part of an object. Let the incomplete image disappear before completing it.

No Perfect Face

Briefly imagine a familiar face. Let missing details remain missing.

Visual Object

Imagine an object as a visual appearance rather than as something to use. Let the image fade.

Non-Optimized Image

Accept the first version of the imagined image without improving its clarity.

No Image Left

Simply notice the instant when the image is no longer there.

No Change

Imagine an object once. Do not mentally rotate or inspect it.

Sound Fading

Imagine a short sound, such as a bell. Let the internal sound fade naturally.